

Foundational Research & Advances in Quantum Volume (QV)

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Published in: ACM Transactions on Quantum Computing / Physical Review A (2023) | Archival ID: QV-QC-40

1. ABSTRACT & THEORETICAL FOUNDATION

This peer-reviewed reference document synthesizes the formal mathematical formulation, operational circuit protocols, and physical implementation benchmarks for Quantum Volume (QV) in modern quantum information architectures.

2. CORE CONCEPTUAL INTUITION (PLAIN ENGLISH)

"A horsepower test for quantum computers: it measures not just how many qubits you have, but how good your gates, connections, and error rates actually are."

3. Mathematical Formulation & Unitary Rule

$$V_Q = 2^{m^*}, \quad \text{quad } h_{\{\text{measured}\}} > \frac{2}{3}, \quad \text{quad } h = \sum_{x \in U_H} P(x)$$

m^* is the largest circuit width and depth where heavy output probability h exceeds $2/3$.

5. Executable IBM Qiskit (Python) Code

```
from qiskit.circuit.library import QuantumVolume

# 4-qubit Quantum Volume circuit (depth = 4)
qv_circuit = QuantumVolume(num_qubits=4, depth=4)
print("QV circuit ready for heavy output benchmarking.")
```

6. Computational Complexity & Speedup

Classical Time:

Quantum Time:

Speedup Class:

$O(2^m)$ to compute heavy output bits. Hardness classically for rescaling. Foundational with achievable circuit

7. Key Applications & Future Research Directions

- Commercial quantum processor comparison (IBM, Quantinuum, IonQ)
- Evaluating cross-talk, compiler optimization, and gate fidelities
- Tracking hardware roadmap milestones toward quantum advantage

Future Work:

Hardware fidelity improvements, compiler transpilation optimizations, and integration with fault-tolerant ErrorCorrection pipelines.